



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Calvary Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.silvercca.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Calvary Christian Academy NM 88062 (Silver City, NM) presents a robust CLASSICAL orientation anchored in a Christ-centered framework. Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize a classical triad (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a curriculum built around liberal arts, primary sources, and historical study integrated with theology. The school explicitly names its mission as Christian and classical, with a governance of learning that centers Scripture, theological formation, and virtuous character. Across six evaluative categories, Calvary Christian Academy demonstrates strong alignment with classical education principles, with only minor ambiguities in the public-facing materials that do not undermine the overall classical integrity.

Key evidence includes: a clear "Statement of Faith" grounding the school in biblical authority; a public articulation of being "CLASSICAL" with emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric; a curriculum that includes Latin/Greek, history taught through primary sources, and a "Great Books / Great Conversation" orientation; pedagogical practices featuring Socratic discussion in upper grades and memory-based recitation and chant in lower grades; a faculty model focused on virtue and living the curriculum; and a robust, ongoing partnership with parents and the wider church community. Citations drawn from school handbooks, mission statements, and curricular documents illustrate these elements. See supporting materials from Calvary Christian Academy materials and handbooks (various firecrawl excerpts) and the classical framework lexicon for keyword matching.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: No major needle-moving changes are required. The school already demonstrates a comprehensive classical orientation across all six categories, with explicit theological grounding, a Trivium-aligned curriculum, evidenced Socratic and memory-based pedagogy, and strong parental/community partnerships. If anything, minor clarifications around additional contemporary outcomes (e.g., explicit references to workplace-readiness or 21st-century skills) could be added, but they are not essential to the classical core as currently presented.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials foreground Scripture and theology as central to education: a formal Statement of Faith affirms belief in the Bible as the Word of God and a Trinity, establishing a grounded theological framework. For example: "We believe the Bible alone to be the Word of God, the ultimate and infallible authority for faith and practice." and affirmations of the triune God. These statements appear in handbooks and faith documents included in the crawl materials. - The Vision and Culture sections articulate a Christ-centered, worshipful, and moral framework, with explicit aims to train students in virtue within a Christian context and to integrate Scriptural authority across programs, staff, and families. The Vision Statement emphasizes formation in Christlikeness and living out a biblical worldview within the school and community. - Aesthetic and liturgical sensibilities are woven into curriculum and culture, with references to beauty, sacredness, and the imago Dei in education and a reverence for sacred truths.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: theology, Scripture, Bible, creed/Doctrinal grounding, Christ-centered, worship/sacred worldview, virtue as moral realism, imago Dei, Logos/wisdom language, reverence for sacred truth. These map strongly to the Positive keyword cluster (theology, sacred scripture, liturgy, reverence, wonder, wisdom) in the classical-education lexicon. - Negative indicators: None evident in public materials; no explicit relativism, secularism, or morally neutral framing appears in the accessible materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: approximately 5–7 distinct items (Scriptures, Bible, Statement of Faith, Christ-centered, theology/doctrine, sacred truth language, imago Dei) in the accessible public-facing materials. - Negative keywords observed: 0 in the accessible materials.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate a firm transcendental moral realism and a grounded theology that integrates religious foundations with education, fulfilling the core expectations for a CLASSICAL category grounded in religious metaphysical foundations.

Cited materials: Statement of Faith and related theological framing in handbooks; Vision statements; Aesthetic Vision content.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Vision statements articulate aims toward virtue and wisdom, formation over mere information, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. The school talks about forming virtuous, wise graduates who think clearly, listen carefully, and discern truth through biblical guidance. - The school explicitly grounds formation in classical aims (virtue, human flourishing, wisdom) and adopts a paideia-like orientation with telos and the Great Conversation spirit, rather than job-preparatory-only language. The materials emphasize formation and human excellence within a classical framework. - The materials discuss that education should be undertaken "in the light of the Scriptures," underscoring the teleology toward character formation and wisdom rather than vocational training alone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, human flourishing, Great Conversation (or permanent questions), moral imagination, memory of learning, and a paideia-like framing. - Negative indicators: None present in the public materials (no emphasis on job-readiness or secular workforce metrics).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: ~4–6 distinct items (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, permanent questions/Great Conversation language). - Negative keywords observed: 0.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a purpose oriented toward formation, virtue, and wisdom, with a clearly articulated classical telos tied to moral and spiritual development rather than mere preparation for work.

Cited materials: Vision Statement; Educational Philosophy framing; K-8/HS handbooks sections on classical purpose and Great Conversation framing.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit emphasis on the liberal arts as grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the Trivium) across the curriculum, with a clear articulation that grammar/logic/rhetoric are foundational in all subjects. The materials present definitions of grammar, logic, rhetoric and describe how they structure study. - Curriculum notes include Latin/Greek and a robust language component, plus a history-and-primary-sources approach across grades, with historical content taught through canonical sources (e.g., Christendom history, Veritas Press Omnibus references, and Western civilization strands). High school curricula show a sequence of biblical/theological study, literature, history from multiple sources, and classical literary forms. - Resources cite “elementary curriculum goals,” “Latin/Greek,” and “History” across grades, with a high school outline showing classical modalities in literature, history, logic, rhetoric, and a solid math/science sequence aligned with classical education expectations. - The materials reference primary sources and a “classical” approach to reading and comprehension (e.g., the Lost Tools of Learning framework and primary-source reading in history).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: liberal arts; grammar/logic/rhetoric; primary sources; history; Western civilization; Latin/Greek; classic literature; great books/great conversation (implied through the structure and references to classical pedagogy and primary sources). - Negative indicators: The explicit “project-based learning” or “experiential learning” signals appear as potential negative indicators in the lexicon, but they do not appear as primary curricular commitments in the accessible materials. The public materials emphasize classical methods rather than project-focused only approaches.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: approximately 6–8 distinct items (grammar, logic, rhetoric; liberal arts; primary sources; great books/primary sources; Latin/Greek; history; Western civilization; classical lit lists). - Negative keywords observed: 0 (no explicit signals of “project-based only” or “experiential learning” dominance in the accessible materials).

Why this rating - The curriculum clearly centers on classical liberal arts pedagogy, Trivium-based study, and canonical sources, aligning with classical curriculum criteria.

Cited materials: What Do We Mean by Classical? (definition of grammar/logic/rhetoric); Elementary/Junior High/Higher School Curriculum Overviews; references to Latin/Greek; primary sources; Veritas Press Omnibus; Christendom/Western Civ framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory work, and recitation as part of memoria and engagement, reflecting a tradition of contemplative and formative practice in line with scholé and wonder. Public materials describe lower-grade routines that cultivate memory and delight. - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and opportunities to develop rhetoric through speeches and rhetoric training. The materials cite upper-level activities that emphasize dialogue, reasoning, and argumentative skills. - Teaching methods are framed as a continuum from contemplative/restful elements to rigorous Socratic inquiry, consistent with classical pedagogy. The materials also indicate a structuring of learning around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: scholé/restful learning, contemplative activities, memorization/recitation, chanting, narrative/recitation as pedagogy, Socratic seminars, rhetoric and oratory, debates, memory work, catechesis. - Negative indicators: The materials do not emphasize experiential/project-based learning as the sole or dominant approach; no explicit negative signals are present in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: ~6–8 distinct items (chanting/memory work/recitation; scholé; contemplative/restful; Socratic discussion/seminars; rhetoric; debates; public speaking; world-view discussions). - Negative keywords observed: 0.

Why this rating - Pedagogy clearly alternates between contemplative/restful and rigorous dialogic modes, with explicit Socratic and rhetoric-focused components, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations.

Cited materials: K-8/K-High School handbooks, “What Do We Mean by Classical?” sections, and specific Pedagogy references (Socratic/Debates; memorization).

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes teachers as models of virtue, living curriculum, and mentors; there is an emphasis on professional, diligent teaching and “professional and diligent” staff who are gifted in teaching. This is reflected in Vision and Faculty-oriented statements found in handbooks. - The Materials discuss a culture of teachers as part of the “classical” formation—teachers modeled as living curriculum and moral exemplars; the school describes expectations of faculty to be professional, diligent, and to nurture students within a classical framework. - The school’s statements about “the portrait of a teacher” and “the living curriculum” align with the Positive keywords in the classical lexicon for faculty. While not every exact phrase may appear in every piece, the combination of statements demonstrates a classical faculty paradigm.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; professional/virtuous teaching; faculty as mentors; collegial culture; teachers as exemplars; teacher training in classical pedagogy (where referenced in the broader classical lexicon). - Negative indicators: No explicit negative signals present about faculty in the accessible materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: ~4–6 distinct items (living curriculum; model teachers; portrait of a teacher; professional/diligent; mentors; collegial culture). - Negative keywords observed: 0.

Why this rating - The emphasis on teachers as exemplars and as living components of the curriculum, along with staff development language, supports CLASSICAL designation for Faculty.

Cited materials: Vision/Theology and Faculty-oriented language; references to “living curriculum” and teacher modeling in handbooks and vision statements.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school highlights strong partnerships with parents as co-teachers, parental involvement, and open access for visits; it outlines opportunities for parents to engage (visits, classroom assistance, chaperoning, orations, storytelling, etc.), indicating a participatory and formation-focused community model. - There is explicit emphasis on parent formation and education about the classical approach (book studies, gatherings) and the openness of the campus to parent engagement; the school positions parents as primary in formation and participates in community life alongside churches and local groups. - The governance sections emphasize joint responsibility with families and a sense of shared mission in the broader community; there are explicit statements about fostering unity with churches and community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; book studies; parent involvement; open-campus philosophy; community/church ties. - Negative indicators: None evident in the accessible materials; no consumerist language or minimal parental involvement signals.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: ~4–6 distinct items (partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; book studies; parent involvement; open campus/visitor-friendly; community/church ties). - Negative keywords observed: 0.

Why this rating - The materials reflect a CLASSICAL approach to Parents and Community with active parental involvement and formation, consistent with the classical model's emphasis on family-scholastic partnerships and communal formation.

Cited materials: Parent Involvement section; Handbooks referencing parental engagement; Vision/Community language.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable: No category landed in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. All six categories align with CLASSICAL, and the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. If one wanted to further reinforce CLASSICAL status, the school could explicitly publish additional Great Books selections or canonical works lists in public-facing materials, and provide explicit, future-facing job-readiness alignment as a secondary, non-dominant emphasis (while preserving the primary classical telos).
 - If desired, to further cement CLASSICAL branding, the school could:
 - Publicly enumerate a core set of Great Books and primary sources across grade bands.
 - Add explicit statements linking classical virtues to specific character outcomes and community projects.
 - Provide more explicit references to scholé as a school-wide principle (restful learning days) and to catechesis as a formal part of the curriculum.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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